

Implementing your choice

The process of implementing an innovation is about project management—making something happen within a budget and to a set timescale. Strategic implementation means thinking about the downstream side of this—can you actually make it happen? Do you have the knowledge and skills that you need—or if not, do you know where to get them? Remember that many innovations involve making strategic alliances, so not having knowledge and skills in-house is not necessarily a barrier here. Have you thought about change-management issues—how to ensure that people elsewhere in the organization will buy in to your planned change? And how will you organize your team to make the innovation happen—who will lead, what balance of skills and experience do you require, and how will you build a high-performing team to deliver the project? All these factors must be considered in advance to give your innovation the best chance of success.

TIP

MANAGE RISK

Make sure you monitor and review your projects regularly as they develop over time. Set clear criteria for success at that stage, and if projects are not working out, do not be afraid to close them down.



CHECKLIST HANDLING INNOVATIVE IDEAS

	YES	NO
• Do you have a clear system for choosing innovation projects?	☐	☐
• Does someone who has a good idea know how to take it forward?	☐	☐
• Do you balance your portfolio with low- and high-risk projects?	☐	☐
• Do you focus on a mixture of innovation with regard to product, process, market, and business model?	☐	☐
• Can you balance “do better” and “do different” innovation?	☐	☐
• Do you recognize the need to work outside of the box?	☐	☐
• Do you have a system to handle off-center but interesting ideas?	☐	☐
• Do you have a structure for corporate venturing?	☐	☐